

much bias and personal baggage they reveal among the critics. This is also evident in our next section on “Media” (later on, we explore what causes this).

Consider *Newsweek*:

Visually they are a nightmare, tight, dandified Edwardian-Beatnik suits and great pudding bowls of hair. Musically they are a near disaster, guitars and drums slamming out a merciless beat that **does away with secondary rhythms, harmony and melody**. (emphasis added)

Whether you like their songs or not, the musicality and beauty of The Beatles’ harmonies and melodies are simply not debatable.

Then there was *The Washington Post*, which revealed a very inside-the-beltway-DC perspective:

They are, apparently, part of some kind of malicious, bi-lateral entertainment trade agreement. The British have to sit through dozens of dreadful American television programs. In return, we get The Beatles. As usual, we got gypped. Nothing we have exported in recent years quite justifies imported hillbillies who look like sheep dogs and sound like alley cats in agony.

What was the 1960s equivalent of, “Okay, Boomer”?

You probably know what happened next: “I Want to Hold Your Hand”²³ went to number one in the US, quickly selling a million copies. American tastes were not so different than Britain’s after all, and Beatlemania became a cultural phenomenon in the US too.²⁴

Ironically, these music “experts” missed the biggest cultural shift in generations, and it was happening right before their eyes and ears. How did they blow it? Derek Thompson’s book *Hit Makers: The Science of Popularity in an Age of Distraction*,²⁵ explains Raymond Loewy’s concept of MAYA—new products that are “most advanced yet acceptable.”